MATTY EASTON

Quantitative Research | Data & Insights Communication | Applied AI & LLMs

matt_easton@berkeley.edu | (801) 662-8410 | linkedin.com/in/matthew-easton | San Francisco Bay Area, CA

***SEEKING*:** Research, insights, and client partnership roles – full-time starting 2027 or Summer 2027 internships

PROFILE

Berkeley PhD researcher and award-winning presenter who turns surveys, experiments, and large-scale text into clear, decision-ready insights for non-technical audiences. 7+ years of experience partnering with stakeholders across public opinion research, tech, political campaigns, and public policy, plus hands-on experience building LLM-powered research pipelines.

SKILLS

Research Methods: Survey design, survey & field experiments, causal inference, statistical regression, network analysis
Quantitative Tools: R, Stata, Python, GitHub, Qualtrics, LLM APIs, natural language processing, text classification
Communication: Tableau, Datawrapper, Adobe Illustrator, executive briefings, public speaking, conference presentation

EXPERIENCE

Doctoral Researcher — UC Berkeley, Political Science *Aug 2021 – Present*
- Lead original end-to-end research projects from study design to vendor selection, fielding, analysis, and executive-ready reporting
- Build and analyze large-scale datasets using AI tools, LLMs, text analysis, and survey experiments to identify emerging narratives, audience attitudes, and behavioral trends among specific demographic groups; apply mixed methods for online network analysis
- Manage multiple research assistants and cross-functional collaborations; present at national conferences and publish in top journals

Research Assistant — Research Collaborative (*Public Opinion*) *Apr 2022 – Present*
- Synthesize public opinion research into biweekly briefings for 200+ senior stakeholders nationwide; manage research database including data collection, cleaning, analysis, and visualization; contribute to new partner outreach efforts
- Build and scale research infrastructure from the ground up — assisting with 300+ surveys and focus groups, developing a stakeholder-facing data portal, and growing team capacity from 2 to 7 — to deliver strategy to partner organizations

Graduate Student Instructor — UC Berkeley, Political Science *Aug 2022 – Jul 2026*
- Led instruction across 8 courses including American Politics, U.S. Congress, and U.S. Presidency; taught 400+ students data analysis, analytical writing, and political thought across 16 sections, including three semesters as head GSI; recognized with Outstanding GSI Award (2024)
- Managed full course operations and mentored a highly selective cohort on academics, research, and professional development

Marketing Associate — Eccovia Solutions (*SaaS Healthcare Technology*) *Jul 2020 – Jul 2021*
- Developed content strategy across 4 digital platforms for healthcare technology; produced weekly client case studies translating complex SaaS capabilities for non-technical audiences; assisted RFP team in proposal editing and vendor marketing

Regional Field Organizer — Pete for America Campaign *Jul 2019 – Feb 2020*
- Recruited, trained, and managed 50+ volunteers and 40+ team leads; achieved benchmarks (15%+ share) in 75%+ of precincts
- Designed and executed community events for over 900 attendees; led 30+ team trainings and weekly constituent conversations

Data Analytics Intern — Y2 Analytics (*Market Research*) *May – Jul 2019*
- Executed 10+ market research projects for political, corporate, and municipal clients; designed end-to-end survey research and translated findings into executive-ready presentations with data visualizations

EDUCATION

University of California, Berkeley *Aug 2021 – Expected 2027*
PhD Candidate, Political Science (American Politics; Methodology; Political Behavior)
MA, Political Science *Apr 2023*
- Fellowships: Citrin Center for Public Opinion Research | Berkeley Center for American Democracy
- Certificates: **University of Oxford** *Spring School in Quantitative Methods 2026* – Text Analysis and Large Language Modeling

Brigham Young University *Apr 2019*
BA, Political Science (Minor: Professional Writing & Rhetoric) GPA: 4.00/4.00
- Valedictorian, Summa Cum Laude — Phi Kappa Phi & Pi Sigma Alpha Honors

LEADERSHIP & ACTIVITIES

Leadership: Co-President, Political Science Graduate Student Association (2024); President, Political Affairs Society (2019); President, Pi Sigma Alpha (2019); Primary Editor, Sigma Research Journal (2019)